Curriculum as a Living Guide for Learning

Kurikulum sebagai Panduan Pembelajaran yang Hidup



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Where does curriculum live?

Opening provocation

Is curriculum in the document, the plan, what the educator does, or what the child experiences?

Type one or two words in the chat.

Reconnect: your compass sentence

From your online work

In my setting the curriculum feels like a ___ because ___

Share your sentence in the chat, or with a partner.

Curriculum is a compass, not a script

Direction without prescribing every step

purpose

direction

shared intentions

space for professional judgement

Flexibility ≠ absence of intention

Knowing the curriculum well makes responsiveness possible.

Four layers of curriculum

Related, but never perfectly identical

INTENDED	*yang dimaksudkan*	What frameworks and goals say we want children to learn
PLANNED	*yang direncanakan*	What educators deliberately design
ENACTED	*yang dilaksanakan*	What actually happens through people, materials and relationships
EXPERIENCED	*yang dialami anak*	What the child encounters, feels, understands and learns

The Australian Early Years Framework (EYLF)

VISION		
BELONGING, BEING AND BECOMING		
PRINCIPLES	**PRACTICES**	**LEARNING OUTCOMES**
• Secure, respectful and reciprocal relationships • Partnerships • Respect for diversity • Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander perspectives • Equity, inclusion and high expectations • Sustainability • Critical reflection and ongoing professional learning • Collaborative leadership and teamwork	• Holistic, integrated and interconnected approaches • Responsiveness to children • Play-based learning and intentionality • Learning environments • Cultural responsiveness • Continuity of learning and transitions • Assessment and evaluation for learning, development and wellbeing	• Children have a strong sense of identity • Children are connected with and contribute to their world • Children have a strong sense of wellbeing • Children are confident and involved learners • Children are effective communicators

LEARNING OUTCOMES



Outcome 1: Children have a strong sense of identity
Outcome 2: Children are connected with and contribute to their world
Outcome 3: Children have a strong sense of well-being
Outcome 4: Children are confident and involved learners
Outcome 5: Children are effective communicators

OUTCOME 5: CHILDREN ARE EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATORS

Children express ideas and make meaning using a range of media

This is evident when children, for example:

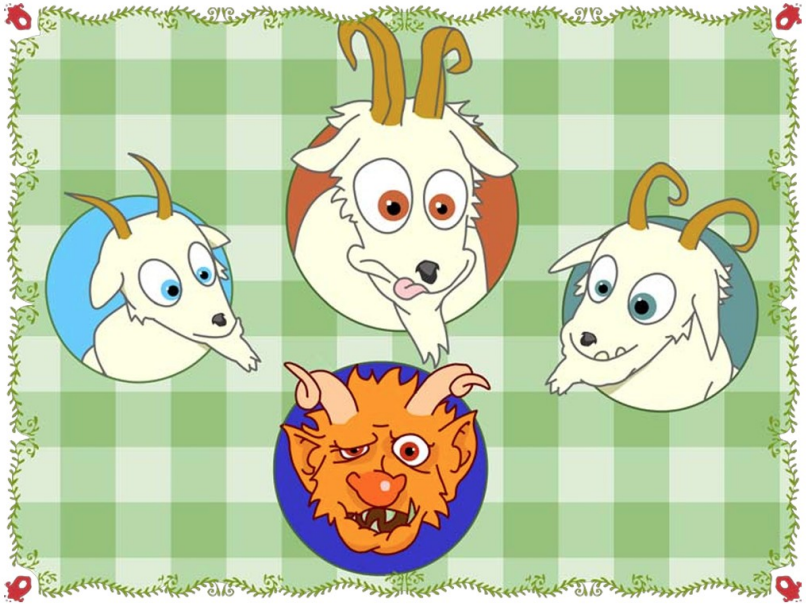
- use language, sounds, gestures and movement to engage in play to imagine and create roles, scripts and ideas
- share the stories and symbols of their own culture and re-enact well-known stories
- use materials to create art works (e.g. drawing, painting, sculpture, drama, dance, movement, music and storytelling) to express ideas and make meaning
- experiment with ways of expressing ideas and meaning using a range of media
- begin to use images and approximations of letters and words to convey meaning
- enjoy engaging with and sharing a wide variety of cultural texts including those authored by Traditional Owners
- display literacy behaviours by incorporating reading and writing approximations and viewing in their play (including digital technologies)
- view, listen and respond to simple printed, visual and multimedia texts or music and express how it makes them feel
- use simple tools and techniques to shape, assemble and join materials they are using
- explore a range of materials and their properties.

Educators promote this learning for all children when they, for example:

- build on children's family and community experiences with creative and expressive arts
- provide a range of resources that enable all children to express meaning through the Arts, including visual arts, dance, drama and music
- ask and answer questions during the reading or discussion of books and other texts
- provide resources that encourage children to experiment with images and print
- teach children skills and techniques that will enhance their capacity for self-expression and communication
- join in children's play and co-construct materials such as signs that extend the play and enhance literacy learning
- respond to children's images and symbols, talking about the elements, principles, skills and techniques they have used in order to convey meaning
- critically reflect on how they are embedding Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander perspectives and voices into every part of their planning and their setting
- use a range of questioning strategies appropriate to each child's capabilities to gain insight into their thinking



The Three Billy Goats Gruff





Learning Story: When a boat becomes a ‘bridge’ across water

Andrew and Gemma sat together during group time, their attention captured by the story “The Three Billy Goats Gruff”. As Chloe, their educator, turned each page she exaggerated emotions and built tension and excitement into the story. The children were listening, their attention held by the dilemma, how could the goats cross the bridge to avoid the troll below? Chloe, watched and listened carefully, noticing the children’s engagement. As the story ended, Gemma turned to Andrew and said, “Maybe they can’t swim, so they had to go on the bridge.” Andrew paused, then replied, “They could use a boat instead.” Recognising the significance of this moment, Chloe made a deliberate pedagogical decision to follow the children’s thinking. “That’s an interesting idea,” she said. “I wonder how we could help the goat cross the river without using the bridge?”

Motivated by their shared idea, Andrew and Gemma moved into the play space, bringing a small doll to represent the goat. An outdoor water trough of water became their river. Andrew placed a wooden block into the water and watched it sink. He said, “That one doesn’t work.” Gemma selected a small container and gently placed it in the water. “It floats!” she exclaimed. Chloe remained close, observing and listening. Based on what she noticed, she made another intentional decision to extend the children’s thinking by introducing a range of materials. She provided an assortment of containers, take-away food containers, yogurt cups, and butter tubs, placing them within reach. “I wonder which of these might work best for your boat?” she asked. Andrew and Gemma began selecting, comparing, and testing the different containers, placing the doll inside each one to see if it would float and stay balanced. When one tipped, Andrew laughed, “It fell in.” Gemma responded, “We need a bigger one.”

Chloe noticed their curiosity growing and chose to introduce the class tablet to further extend their ideas. She asked, “Would you like to look at some real boats to get some ideas?” Together, they explored images of different types of boats. Gemma pointed to one image on the screen saying, “that one keeps the water out, it has a sail” Inspired by what they saw, Andrew and Gemma returned to their designs with new ideas. They selected different containers, tested them in the water, and adjusted their choices based on what stayed afloat and carried their doll. Throughout the experience, Chloe continued to make responsive decisions, when to offer materials, when to introduce new tools, and when to step back, guided by what she could see and hear in the children’s play.





When a boat becomes a ‘bridge’ across water

Has the curriculum been interrupted, or has it become alive?

PLANNED

Story-time = listening and oral language development

→

CHILDREN NOTICE A NEW POSSIBILITY

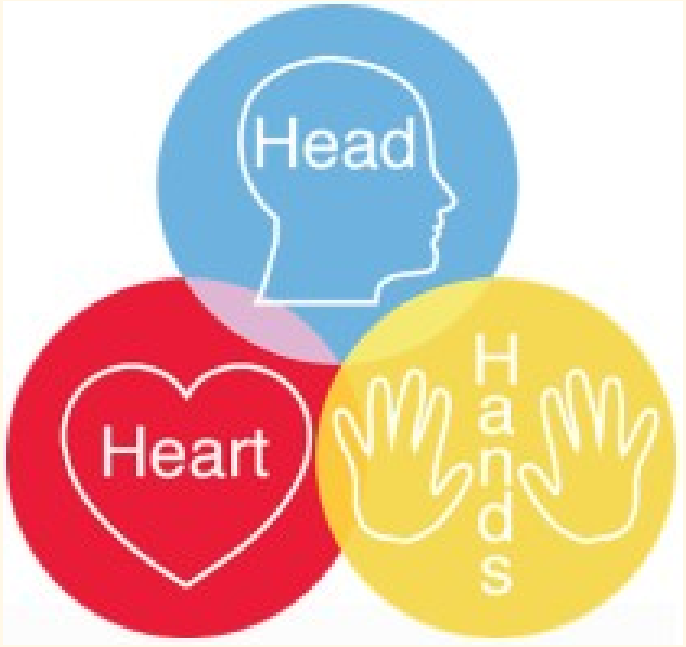
Building a boat to cross the water; floating and sinking

What learning is now visible?

- design
- measurement
- collaboration
- persistence
- language
- physical properties

Humanistic Philosophy:

How do we understand children's learning?



Mindful
Meaningful
Joyful

Breakout 1: Is this living curriculum?

7 minutes | groups of 3 to 5. Do not rush to design a new activity. Stay with the learning already happening.

1. What are the children doing?
2. What might they be thinking?
3. What capabilities are visible?
4. How could this be mindful, meaningful and joyful?
5. What pedagogical decision would you make next, and why?

Child-centred does not mean educator-absent

Provocation

“Following children’s interests is not enough.”

AGREE | **UNSURE** | **DISAGREE**

What is the risk of adult control?
What is the risk of ‘anything goes’?

Living curriculum is co-constructed

Purpose + child contribution + educator intentionality

CHILD

interests + theories
questions
capabilities
culture + lived experience

LIVING CURRICULUM

Purpose + child contribution + educator intentionality

Intentionality can include waiting.

EDUCATOR

curriculum knowledge
pedagogical expertise
ethical responsibility
professional judgement

Reflection

Make the conceptual shift visible. Post one sentence in the chat, or keep it as a private reflection.

I USED TO THINK…

NOW I THINK…

I WONDER…

Break

15 minutes | Istirahat

We will return at: _____

When we return: How do I decide what to do next?

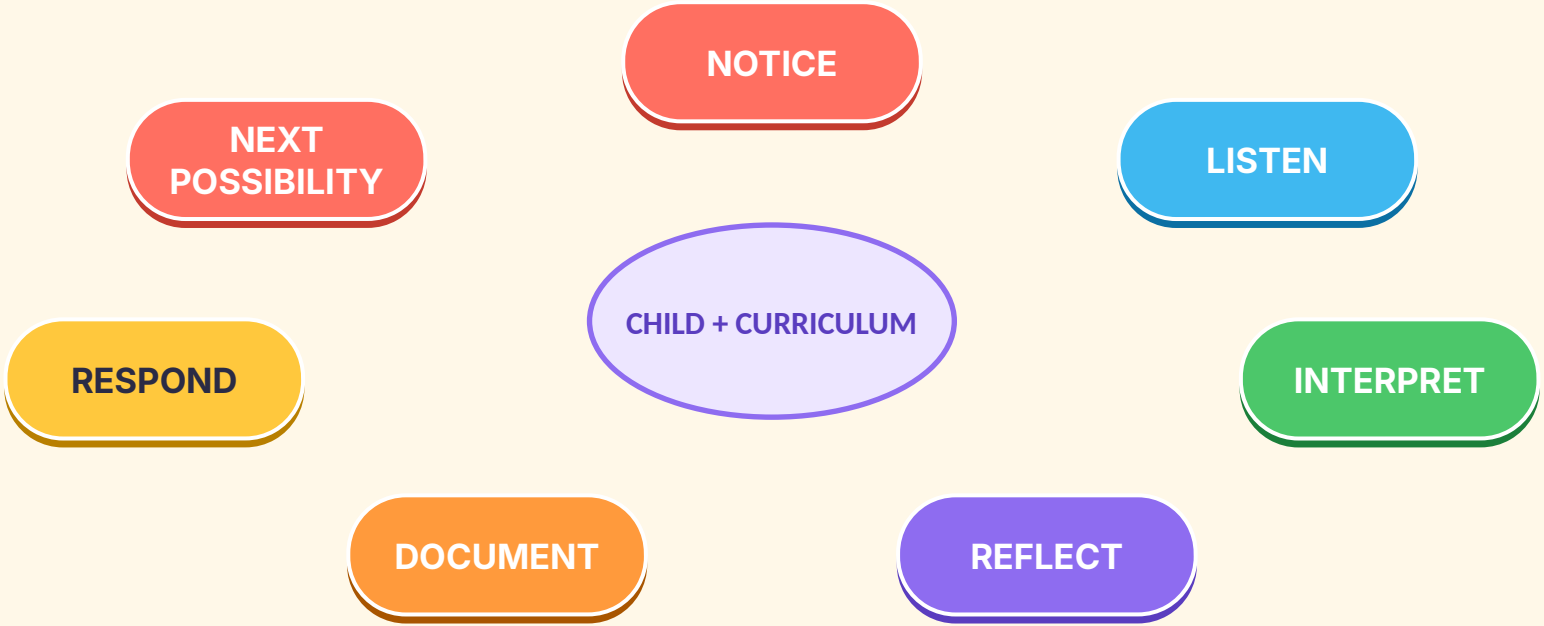
Bringing the Curriculum to Life

Menghidupkan kurikulum

How do we move from noticing children's learning to intentionally extending it?
HOW DO I DECIDE WHAT TO DO NEXT?

The Living Curriculum Cycle

A thinking tool, not another compliance template. Evidence continually informs the next decision.



Learning Story: It Goes Fast Here!

Stacey and Hank sat together in the outdoor learning space, their attention drawn to a simple setup, a plank resting on a low crate, forming a ramp. A container of water and a collection of cups and loose parts sat nearby. Emma, their educator, watched closely, noticing the "bright centre" of their learning beginning to form. Stacey carefully poured water from a cup onto the top of the ramp and exclaimed, "Look, it's going fast." Hank crouched down, following the stream with his finger. "It goes fast here" he said while pointing to the top of the ramp. They were playfully exploring science ideas and wondering "how does water flow?", noticing speed, direction, and water movement.

Emma leaned into the children's play gently and with shared interest saying, "I wonder what makes the water move faster or slower?" Hank stopped for a moment, looking around and then he stood up and grabbed another plank. "This one is longer" he said, placing it beside the first. Without prompting, their exploration expanded outward, like the soft halo around a torch beam into mathematical thinking as they compared length and height.

Emma fostered their thinking by asking, "Which ramp do you think will make the water go fastest?" Then with a construction approach the focus of their learning beam extended into engineering thinking as the children began adjusting their ramps, experimenting with crates and blocks. Hank stacked two crates while saying "It needs to be higher to go faster." Emma guided their process with intention and made a STEM connection for the children. She commented, "you're changing your design to see what works best. That's what e[illegible]"

Text Effects

Noticing the children's joy and engagement with the STEM experience, Emma introduced the classroom iPad and asked, "Would you like to record what your water does?" With help from Emma, Stacey took the iPad, filming as Hank poured water. "Now we can watch it again!" she said. Together with Emma guiding their use of the iPad, they replayed the video, comparing different ramp designs.







It goes fast here!

A short play episode

Stacey

Stacey carefully poured water from a cup onto the top of the ramp and exclaimed, "Look, it's going fast."

Hank

Hank crouched down, following the stream with his finger. "It goes fast here" he said while pointing to the top of the ramp.

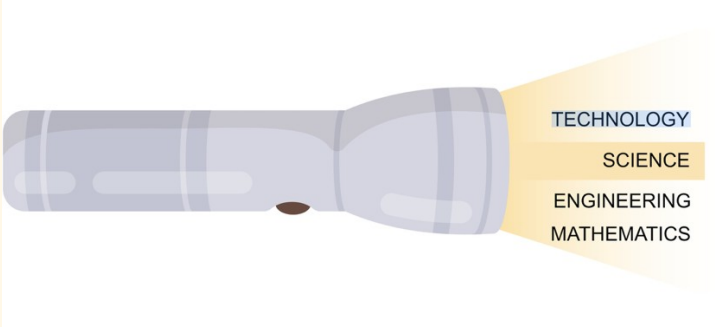
Together

Together they experimented with pouring cups of water. Hank then stacked two crates while saying "It needs to be higher to go faster."

EDUCATOR → “I wonder what makes the water move faster or slower”

Reflecting

What do we see and learn?



Like a torch shining in the dark, Stacey and Hank's learning began with a clear, focused curiosity, wondering how water flows. From this bright centre of play, their initial science thinking naturally radiated outward:

- Into 'Mathematics', into 'Engineering', then into 'Technology', as they recorded and reflected using a digital tool

Evidence first

For this round, do NOT tell me what the children learned

WHAT DID YOU SEE + HEAR?

EVIDENCE

observable actions
words spoken
sequence of events

INTERPRETATION

what we think it might mean

If you interpret, I will ask: What did you observe that made you think that?

Now interpret

What might be happening beneath the behaviour? Interpretations are hypotheses. What evidence supports yours?

prediction	sequencing	number
spatial reasoning	cause + effect	digital skills
communication	collaboration	persistence

Two planning logics

Where does the child enter the curriculum process?

OPTION A



Curriculum can be planned from outcomes, but it must not stop us noticing children.

OPTION B



Breakout 2: Become the educator

10 minutes | continue the learning already happening. Choose ONE pedagogical response your group can justify from the evidence.

1 NOTICE
What evidence can you see?

2 INTERPRET
What might the children be learning/thinking?

3 CURRICULUM
Which priorities connect meaningfully?

4 RESPOND
What could the educator do now?

5 EXTEND
What new possibility could be offered?

6 ASSESS
What would you observe next?

Intentionality has many forms

Intentional teaching / constant adult intervention. The decision is intentional when it is deliberate, evidence-informed and connected to learning.

QUESTION

RESOURCE

ENVIRONMENT

LANGUAGE

MODEL

COLLABORATE

WAIT + OBSERVE

Assessment for learning

Evidence that changes what we do next. Assessment is part of the learning cycle, not simply an end-point judgement.

1. What do I know now about this child?
2. What evidence led me to that interpretation?
3. What might I offer next?

My Living Curriculum Action

Bridge today's learning to tomorrow's practice. Choose something REAL, not your most impressive example.

1. Children are currently interested in / exploring…
2. I notice…
3. This may tell me…
4. The curriculum helps me recognise…
5. My intentional response could be…
6. I will look for evidence of…
7. Depending on what I observe, the next possibility might be…

A compass cannot walk the journey for us.

Curriculum cannot make the pedagogical decision for us.

What will YOU notice differently?

Living Curriculum in Action





A living curriculum

Living curriculum emerges in the relationship between curriculum intentions, children's lives and educators' professional judgement.

DIRECTION

Curriculum gives us direction.

INFORMATION

Children give us information.

INTENTIONAL DECISIONS

Educators make intentional decisions.